The first phase is the Render phase. During initial rendering or any re-rendering triggered by a change in state or props, React creates a new Virtual DOM tree and determines what needs to change—without touching the actual DOM or blocking the browser's main thread.

This Virtual DOM tree is a lightweight JavaScript object representation of the UI. Each node in the tree contains the following attributes:

- *type*—The type of element (e.g., `h1`, `div`, etc.)
- *props*—An object holding the element's attributes such as `id`, `className`, and event handlers.
- *children*—The child elements or text nodes of the component.

For example, consider this simple React component:

```
const App = <h1>Hello, World!</h1>;
```

Its Virtual DOM representation would be:

```
{
  "type": "h1",
  "props": {
    "children": "Hello, World!"
  }
}
```

For a slightly more complex component with nested elements:

```
const App = (
  <div>
    <h1>Hello</h1>
    <p>World</p>
  </div>
);
```

The Virtual DOM representation would look like this:

```
{
  "type": "div",
  "props": {
    "children": [
```